

Human Capital Management, Governance Standards, and Operational Compliance: A Comparative Analysis of GFL Environmental Inc.

Introduction and Organizational Disambiguation

When evaluating corporate governance and human capital policies, it is necessary to distinguish between entities that share similar nomenclature but operate in entirely different jurisdictions and industrial sectors. A review of compliance records reveals two distinct entities: GFL Environmental Inc. and GFL Limited (historically associated with Gujarat Fluorochemicals Limited).¹ Conflating these organizations can lead to regulatory and analytical errors, as their human resources, corporate conduct, and risk management strategies are tailored to their specific operational environments.¹

GFL Environmental Inc. is a major, diversified North American environmental services provider offering solid waste management, liquid waste management, and soil remediation across Canada and the United States.³ This capital-intensive, logistically complex operation employs over twenty thousand personnel and manages a large commercial transport fleet, requiring strict compliance with transportation safety and heavy industrial labor regulations.³

In contrast, GFL Limited is an chemical and manufacturing company based in India.¹ Its corporate governance policies are designed around asset protection, chemical manufacturing compliance, and regional equity investment rules.¹ These differences in governance focus and operational scale are outlined in the table below.

Table 1: Organizational Disambiguation and Governance Baselines

Governance Parameter	GFL Environmental Inc.	GFL Limited (India)
Primary Industry	Solid & liquid waste management, soil remediation ³	Chemical processing and fluorochemical manufacturing ²
Geographic Footprint	United States and Canada ³	India and associated international chemical markets ²
Workforce Scale	High-volume operational workforce (20,000+)	Mid-scale manufacturing operations (51–100)

	employees) ³	employees) ⁷
Conflict of Interest Focus	Workplace personal relationships and direct reporting lines ⁸	Personal investments (>2% ownership in competitors) and relative negotiations ¹
Oversight and Channels	Board-level Audit Committee, CLO, and corporate Whistleblower Hotline ⁸	Proprietary, web-based 'Ethics Line' online channel ²

Human Rights Policy Framework and ESG Integration

GFL Environmental Inc. has structured its corporate identity around the "Green For Life" vision, positioning its workforce as its primary organizational asset.¹⁰ This commitment is codified through its core corporate policies, most notably its Human Rights Policy, which outlines the expectations for ethical, safe, and respectful operations.⁹ Originally structured as a ten-principle framework, GFL updated its Human Rights Policy to incorporate eleven principles, signaling an ongoing effort to align its governance structures with evolving international benchmarks.⁹ This policy is guided by foundational global standards, including the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, the International Bill of Human Rights, and the International Labor Organization's 1998 Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work.⁹ An analysis of GFL Environmental's policy evolution reveals a transition from traditional compliance-driven metrics to a focus on employee integration and psychological safety.⁹ The 2025 policy update specifically reframed the "Diversity and Inclusion" principle into "Inclusion and Belonging".⁹ This shift suggests a recognition that representation alone is insufficient; long-term talent retention relies on fostering an active sense of community and support.⁹ Beyond internal operations, GFL Environmental mandates that its independent contractors and suppliers adhere to these values through its Supplier Code of Conduct.¹⁰ The company reserves the right to audit suppliers to ensure compliance with labor and human rights standards, including the prohibition of forced labor, human trafficking, and child labor.¹⁰ These social compliance efforts are integrated into GFL's broader Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) strategy.⁹ For example, the company's community engagement includes the "Full Circle Project," which allows customers to direct a portion of GFL's corporate donations to local charities.⁹ This aligns the social and environmental aspects of GFL's business model with its long-term sustainability goals.⁹

Table 2: Comparison of GFL Environmental Inc. Human Rights Policy Versions

Governance Principle	2023 Human Rights Policy Standard	2025 Human Rights Policy Standard
Core Principle Name	Diversity and Inclusion ¹¹	Inclusion and Belonging ⁹
Scope of Application	Employees, officers, and Board of Directors ¹¹	All personnel, independent contractors, and suppliers ⁹
Total Core Principles	10 Principles ¹¹	11 Principles ⁹
Accommodations	Standard disability reasonable accommodations ¹¹	Expanded accommodations for disabilities and religious beliefs ⁹
Supply Chain Check	Unspecified/Standard Supplier Code ¹¹	Explicit onboarding screenings for labor law compliance ⁹

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion: The Women in Waste Initiative

The waste management and heavy transport sectors have historically experienced low female representation in frontline operational roles.¹⁵ To address this talent bottleneck and improve workforce diversity, GFL Environmental launched its "Women in Waste" (WIW) initiative.¹¹ This program began in 2018 in GFL's Eastern Canadian hauling operations to recruit and retain female drivers.¹⁶ By 2019, GFL expanded the initiative by launching the WIW success story series on its social media channels to highlight women working in non-traditional roles.¹⁶ The company also established a corporate women leaders' group, an employee resource group providing mentorship and professional development for female personnel at the Director level and above.¹⁶

Following field surveys in 2020 to identify barriers to long-term career progression, GFL established a virtual support network for frontline female operators.¹⁶ This structured support has led to measurable shifts in leadership demographics.¹⁵ In GFL's Eastern Canadian operations, four of the five largest hauling yards by revenue are managed by women who advanced through the ranks into leadership roles.¹⁶ Additionally, GFL's executive leadership team is comprised of 40 percent women.¹⁵

The career paths of key personnel illustrate the operational impact of these programs:

- Heather Roper (General Manager):** A 25-year waste industry veteran, Roper joined GFL in April 2018, having previously held positions in sales, customer service, dispatch, and operations supervision.¹⁵ As General Manager, Roper doubled the number of women working at her sites and has mentored female candidates entering frontline operations.¹⁵

She also served as President and board member of the Hamilton Transportation Club, advocating for women in commercial transport.¹⁵

- **Kristine Szpulak (Logistics Manager / Fleet Maintenance Manager):** Szpulak has served as a mentor for women entering fleet maintenance and logistics roles, helping GFL build its pipeline of female technical talent.¹²

Externally, GFL maintains representation in the National Waste & Recycling Association (NWRA) Women's Council, an organization dedicated to advancing the careers of women in the waste and recycling industry through professional development, networking, and academic scholarships.¹⁸ GFL's Stephanie Sidler serves as Treasurer on the Women's Council leadership team, helping align GFL's internal diversity initiatives with broader industry efforts.¹⁸

Professional Ethics, Corporate Conduct, and Conflict Mitigation

GFL Environmental Inc.'s corporate governance is defined by its Code of Ethics, last updated in August 2024, which serves as its Sarbanes-Oxley Section 406 "code of ethics" for principal financial officers.⁸ The Code requires representatives to act with honesty, integrity, and good professional ethics, avoiding even the appearance of improper behavior.⁸ It prohibits bribery, kickbacks, and anti-competitive practices, such as discussing prices, costs, margins, or discounts with competitors.⁸

A key human resources control in GFL's Code of Ethics is the regulation of close personal relationships in the workplace (such as spouses, partners, children, siblings, or romantic involvements).⁸ When personal relationships overlap with potential conflicts of interest—such as direct reporting lines, internal audit controls, or compensation influence—employees must immediately disclose this to the Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO).⁸ The CHRO and the executive team then determine how to manage the conflict, which often involves reassigning one of the parties.⁸ Other potential conflicts must be reported to the Chief Legal Officer (CLO), while directors must disclose conflicts and abstain from voting on affected matters.⁸

GFL Limited (India) maintains its own set of guidelines, which prohibit officers from holding personal investments greater than 2% in any customer, supplier, or competitor, and require formal approval for transactions involving relatives.¹ These parallel ethical frameworks illustrate how corporate entities implement specific oversight controls tailored to their operational regions.¹

In analyzing historical governance documentation, some regulatory compilations include legacy guidelines from acquired operations, such as Great Lakes and its affiliated companies, which established early benchmarks for equal employment opportunity, anti-harassment, and strict computer resource controls.²⁰ These historical standards emphasized equal employment opportunity, anti-harassment protections, and specific computer resource controls, which prohibited the transmission of sexually explicit, profane, or unlawful materials.²⁰

Talent Attraction and Retention: Standard vs. Unionized Compensation and Benefit Architectures

To attract and retain a qualified workforce across North America, GFL Environmental offers a variety of health, retirement, and wellness programs.¹² Because GFL operates in both the United States and Canada, its benefits are geographically segmented, offering 401(k) programs in the U.S. and Registered Retirement Savings Plans (RRSP) in Canada.¹²

For non-unionized U.S. employees, health, dental, vision, mental health, and disability coverages are available to full-time workers operating 30 or more hours per week.¹² GFL uses a wellness-linked surcharge structure to encourage healthy behaviors and manage healthcare costs.²¹ The plan applies a \$46.00 bi-weekly (\$23.00 weekly) surcharge for tobacco users and for employees whose spouses are eligible for health benefits through their own employers but choose to enroll in GFL's plan instead.²¹

In contrast, unionized environments operate under separate negotiated terms.⁵ For instance, Teamster Local 988 employees are limited to life, AD&D, and disability insurances.²¹ Meanwhile, the collective agreement with Teamsters Local 213 in British Columbia provides immediate group health benefits upon completing probation, with all premium costs paid by GFL.⁵ It also mandates a pension plan where employees contribute 6% of their regular earnings and GFL matches with a 3% RRSP contribution.⁵ These diverse benefit plans reflect GFL's efforts to balance standard corporate cost controls with the requirements of unionized agreements.⁵

Table 3: Benefit Structure, Surcharges, and Pension Plans (U.S. Standard vs. Teamsters Local 213)

Benefit Parameter	2025 GFL U.S. Benefits Standard	Teamsters Local 213 (B.C. Canada)
Eligibility Window	Full-time employees working 30+ hours/week ²¹	First day of month following probation ⁵
Premium Funding	Employee-funded with employer contributions ²¹	100% employer-paid premium costs ⁵
Alternative Spousal Coverage	\$46.00 bi-weekly (\$23.00 weekly) surcharge ²¹	Not applicable; fully covered under group contract ⁵
Tobacco Usage Penalty	\$46.00 bi-weekly (\$23.00 weekly) surcharge ²¹	Not applicable; no health behavioral surcharges ⁵
Retirement / Savings	401(k) Retirement Savings Program ¹²	6% employee, 3% GFL matched RRSP contribution ⁵

Dependent Verification	Required via Clearify/ClearTrack HR under age 26 ²¹	Standard group insurance enrollment guidelines ⁵
-------------------------------	--	---

Workplace Safety, Compliance, and Substance Screening Methodologies

GFL operates in physically demanding environments, exposing workers to extreme weather, heavy mechanical operations, and public road traffic.²² While corporate policies prioritize safety and compliance, employee feedback on platforms such as Indeed highlights challenges with consistent safety enforcement and organizational structure in some local yards.²³

To manage these risks and maintain compliance, GFL uses a dual-track substance screening program.⁶ For safety-sensitive roles (such as CDL drivers), GFL is bound by Department of Transportation (D.O.T.) regulations under 49 CFR Part 40, which require a negative pre-employment urine drug screen and a valid D.O.T. medical card.⁶ These employees are placed in a random testing pool within 30 days of hiring and are tested for five drug classes using strict cutoff levels, with failures reported to the FMCSA Drug & Alcohol Clearinghouse.⁶ For non-safety-sensitive roles, GFL retains the discretion to define its testing methods and panels, including urine, hair, saliva, or breath tests.²⁵ The Code of Ethics strictly prohibits employees from reporting to work or remaining on duty under the influence of alcohol, illegal drugs, or misused legal drugs, establishing clear rules for maintaining a safe and sober workplace.¹⁹

Table 4: D.O.T. Substance Screening Cutoff Concentrations

Drug Class / Analyte	Initial Test Cutoff (ng/mL)	Confirmatory Test Cutoff (ng/mL)
Marijuana Metabolites (THC)	50	15
Cocaine Metabolite	150	100
Codeine / Morphine	2000	2000
Hydrocodone / Hydromorphone	300	100
Oxycodone /	100	100

Oxymorphone		
6-Acetylmorphine (Heroin)	10	10
Phencyclidine (PCP)	25	25
Amphetamine / Methamphetamine	500	250
MDMA / MDA	500	250

Operational Infrastructure and Centralized Access Portals

GFL manages its administrative, compliance, and employee services through centralized digital platforms.²¹ The Employee Self-Service (ESS) portal, accessible at agile.gflenv.com/ESS/Login.aspx, supports Single Sign-On (SSO) and serves as the primary system for payroll, tax documentation, and localized HR inquiries.²⁹ The MyAccount platform, located at myaccount.gflenv.com, integrates with Microsoft, Google, and GFL Azure Active Directory, providing employees with secure access to corporate training, policy documents, and benefit enrollment systems.²⁸ General benefits management and qualified life event reporting are integrated into Workday²¹, supported by Benefit Advocates who assist new hires with their benefit selections.²¹

For corporate compliance, legal affairs, or general inquiries, communication is routed through GFL's regional offices and corporate headquarters.³ GFL Environmental Inc.'s corporate operations are headquartered at 4208, 84 Ave, Edmonton, Alberta, T6B 3N5, Canada, with phone support at +1 578 4389433.³ The U.S. regional corporate office is located at 3010 Hwy 378, Conway, South Carolina, 29527, with telephone support at (843) 397-5586 and toll-free at (800) 421-5625.³⁰

Strategic Conclusions and Governance Recommendations

An evaluation of GFL Environmental Inc.'s corporate governance structure reveals a strong policy framework, characterized by its updated Human Rights Policy, Supplier Code of Conduct, and comprehensive Code of Ethics.⁸ The "Women in Waste" program has made notable progress in recruiting and promoting women in non-traditional roles, supported by external networks like the NWRA Women's Council.¹⁶ GFL also effectively manages conflicts of interest through centralized reporting to the CHRO, reducing risk and ensuring compliance.⁸ However, several operational challenges remain. The divergence between standard U.S.

benefits and Canadian unionized agreements requires ongoing coordination, while employee feedback highlights a need for more consistent safety enforcement at local hauling yards.⁵ To address these challenges and strengthen its compliance posture, GFL should consider the following initiatives:

- **Standardize Local Safety Audits:** Implement a centralized oversight system to monitor local compliance with health and safety policies, addressing employee concerns regarding yard-level disorganization.
- **Refine Substance Screening Communication:** Ensure that drug testing methodologies, such as hair follicle testing for non-D.O.T. roles, are clearly explained to prospective candidates, balancing recruitment efficiency with workplace safety.
- **Enforce Supplier Onboarding Screens:** Use GFL's audit rights to actively monitor supplier compliance with labor standards, safeguarding the company's brand reputation and ensuring compliance with modern slavery reporting guidelines.

Works cited

1. Company Codes - GFL Limited, accessed June 4, 2026, https://www.gflimited.co.in/corporate_governance.html
2. GFL - Ethics Line - Gujarat Fluorochemicals Limited, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://gfl.co.in/ethics-line.php>
3. GFL Environmental - HR.com, accessed June 4, 2026, https://www.hr.com/directory/company/gfl_environmental_inc_2
4. GFL Environmental Inc. email address and contacts, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://getprospect.com/business-directory/gflenvironmental>
5. COLLECTIVE AGREEMENT BETWEEN: GFL ENVIRONMENTAL SERVICES INC. (KELOWNA) AND TEAMSTERS LOCAL UNION No. 213 April 14, 2024 - BC Bargaining Database, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://www.bcbargaining.ca/content/4325/GFL%20Teamsters%20213%202026.pdf>
6. DOT Pre Employment Drug Test Guide - Workforce QA, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://wfqa.com/dot-pre-employment-drug-test/>
7. GFL Environmental Revenue, Funding & Valuation - Prospeo, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://prospeo.io/c/gfl-environmental-revenue>
8. CODE OF ETHICS Section 1 Purpose The purpose of this Code of ..., accessed June 4, 2026, https://s24.q4cdn.com/409248530/files/doc_downloads/2024/08/gfl-code-of-ethics-aug-2024.pdf
9. Human Rights Policy, accessed June 4, 2026, https://s24.q4cdn.com/409248530/files/doc_downloads/2025/04/GFL-Human-Rights-Policy-February-24-2025.pdf
10. SUPPLIER CODE OF CONDUCT - GFL Environmental, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://gflenvironmental.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/12/GFL-Supplier-Code-of-Conduct-February-7-2024.pdf>
11. Human Rights Policy, accessed June 4, 2026,

- http://s24.q4cdn.com/409248530/files/governance_documents/2023/February9Updates/GFL-Human-Rights-Policy.pdf
12. Life at GFL | Culture, Benefits, Growth, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://careers.gflenv.com/life-at-gfl>
 13. Sustainability - Governance Documents - GFL Environmental Inc. - Investor Relations, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://investors.gflenv.com/English/esg/governance-documents/default.aspx>
 14. GFL Environmental Reports Fourth Quarter and Full Year 2023 Results; Provides Full Year 2024 Guidance, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://investors.gflenv.com/English/news/news-details/2024/GFL-Environmental-Reports-Fourth-Quarter-and-Full-Year-2023-Results-Provides-Full-Year-2024-Guidance/default.aspx>
 15. Women in Waste series Heather Roper | GFL Environmental, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://gflenv.com/women-in-waste-series-heather-roper/>
 16. 2021 Sustainability Report, accessed June 4, 2026, https://s24.q4cdn.com/409248530/files/governance_documents/2022/November/GFL2021SustainabilityReport.pdf
 17. Kristine Szpulak: a leader for women in waste - GFL Environmental Inc., accessed June 4, 2026, <https://gflenv.com/kristine-szpulak-a-leader-for-women-in-waste/>
 18. Women's Council - National Waste & Recycling Association, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://wasterecycling.org/member-networks/womens-council/>
 19. CODE OF ETHICS Section 1 Purpose The purpose of this Code of Ethics ("Code") is to communicate GFL Environmental Inc.'s co, accessed June 4, 2026, https://s24.q4cdn.com/409248530/files/governance_documents/2022/GFL-Code-of-Ethics.pdf
 20. Code of Business Conduct & Ethics Compliance Handbook, accessed June 4, 2026, http://media.corporate-ir.net/media_files/irol/20/207587/governance/conduct.pdf
 21. 2025 GFL U.S. Benefits Guide_Standard_final (Page 4) - Flipbook by lindsayobrentz, accessed June 4, 2026, https://fliphtml5.com/vtefd/gimi/2025_GFL_U.S._Benefits_Guide_Standard_final/4/
 22. Residential Waste Helper - Careers at GFL, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://careers.gflenv.com/residential-waste-helper/job/70E0A520D91BB324B7A335D9545E6BA5>
 23. Working at GFL Environmental: Employee Reviews about Pay and benefits | Indeed.com, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://www.indeed.com/cmp/Gfl-Environmental/reviews?fcountry=ALL&ftopic=paybenefits&ftext=equipment>
 24. Working at GFL Environmental: Employee Reviews about Work-life balance | Indeed.com, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://www.indeed.com/cmp/Gfl-Environmental/reviews?ftopic=wbalance&ftext=safety>
 25. Non-DOT Drug Testing: What You Need to Know | Cative, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://www.cative.com/blog/non-dot-drug-testing>
 26. Describe the drug test process at GFL Environmental, if there is one | Indeed.com,

accessed June 4, 2026,

<https://www.indeed.com/cmp/Gfl-Environmental/faq/describe-the-drug-test-process-at-gfl-environmental-if-there-is-one?guid=1f66uo16vt4uk800>

27. Understanding DOT Pre-Employment Drug Testing | Fastest Labs, accessed June 4, 2026,

<https://www.fastestlabs.com/blog/dot-testing/understanding-dot-pre-employment-drug-testing/>

28. Sign up or sign in, accessed June 4, 2026, <https://myaccount.gflenv.com/>

29. accessed June 4, 2026, <https://agile.gflenv.com/ESS/Login.aspx>

30. GFL Environmental - North Myrtle Beach, accessed June 4, 2026,

<https://www.explorenorthmyrtlebeach.com/listing/gfl-environmental/746/>